Sixteenth Summit: Thimpu, 28–29 April 2010

The Sixteenth SAARC Summit was slated for 2009 and was to be hosted by Maldives, but it backed out from hosting the Summit due to global recession. This opportunity was seized by Bhutan and it hosted the 16th SAARC Summit from 28–29 April, 2010.

The theme of the 16th summit was "Towards a green and happy South Asia". Commemortaing the silver jubilee year, the 16th SAARC Summit adopted the 36-point Thimpu Silver Jubilee Declaration which upholds a pledge to make the regional association effective. The Summit also announced the "Thimpu Statement on Climate Change".

The noteworthy developments in this Summit have been the signing of the SAARC Agreement on Trade in Services and the SAARC Convention on Environment. The leaders also held talks in the area of strengthening regional cooperation by way of forming South Asia Forum for generation of debate, discussion and exchange of ideas on future development. The other issues were: people-centric development and the concept of Gross National happiness, poverty alleviation and realization of SAARC Development Goals (SDGs), education, connectivity, food security, energy security, terrorism, global climate change, women and youth, nomination of a Woman Secretary General as the tenth Secretary General of SAARC, and development of a SAARC Youth Action Plan to guide regional cooperation. The summit further underlined the important role of the SAARC Development Fund (SDF) for financing regional and sub-regional programmes and projects.

However, there was no progress on SAFTA (South Asia Free Trade Agreement) though the leaders reiterated to uphold their commitment to implement the SAFTA in letter and spirit. No effort was also made by the leaders of South Asia to find out any regional solution to the Afghan problem.

Seventeenth Summit: Addu, Maldives, 10–11 November 2011

The Seventeenth Summit was held from 10–11 November 2011 in Addu City, Maldives. The Meeting was opened by the outgoing Chair of SAARC, Prime Minister of the Royal Government of Bhutan,